The middle and the spread

Data science · Level 1 · Lesson 2



Today we will

- Work out the mean, median and mode.
- See how one extreme value pulls the mean.
- Measure the spread with the range.

Remember

- Mean: share it out equally.
- Median: the middle one; it resists extremes.
- Always give a spread with the middle.

A human number line

1. Warm-up (5 min): One number for the whole class?
2. Teach (8 min): Mean, median, mode, range.
3. Measure (15 min): Line up by hand span.
4. Extreme (7 min): Add the teacher.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): What did we find out?

Let’s discuss

1. Why did the median barely move when the teacher joined?
2. When is the mode the only middle you can use?
3. What does a big range tell a teacher?

Exit ticket

- For 2, 4, 4 and 10, write the mean, the median, the mode and the range.